Closure, Realization, and Reflective Residue:

A Machine-Checked Synthesis of NEMS, Infinity Compression, and APS with Bridge Theorems and the Non-Erasure Principle

Nova Spivack

Independent Researcher

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Code/Data availability: Lean 4 formalization: `reflexive-architecture-lean` (this repo). Build: `lake update && lake exe cache get && lake build`. Zero `sorry` in proof terms under `ReflexiveArchitecture/`. See `MANIFEST.md` and `STRATA_FORMALIZATION_MAP.md` at the project root. Supporting corpora: [5, 6, 4]. NEMS, APS, and IC references below are suite-internal preprints (2026); they are not yet external journal publications.

Abstract

Three research lines developed in parallel now admit a common structural formalization: they have been unified in a machine-checked Lean 4 development at the abstract architecture level, with zero proof placeholders. The NEMS program proves that load-bearing determinacy cannot be outsourced: if a framework is non-categorical under closure, some internal selector is forced, and in diagonal-capable settings that selector cannot collapse to a total-effective decider on the relevant self-referential fragment. The APS program proves that indexed composition is neither automatic from self-reference nor a vague closure property: it is exactly finite tracking plus gluing, so fixed-point abundance alone does not suffice for global uniform realization. Infinity Compression proves that canonical theorem-level certification does not exhaust reflective structure: enriched realization above the bare certificate is irreducibly plural, and any adequate certification route must instantiate split/refinement/fiber architecture.

This paper presents the machine-checked synthesis of these three lines as the Strata program. NEMS governs the *outer admissibility law*; APS governs the *exact local-to-global architecture required for uniform realization*; Infinity Compression governs the *inner reflective geometry* of canonical certification.

The formalization proceeds in three milestones, all clean. **Milestone 1** (abstract architecture and anti-collapse): defines an abstract class ReflexiveArchitecture, proves a layered architecture theorem showing that all three structural conclusions hold jointly, and proves a stratified non-collapse theorem showing the three layers resist simultaneous flattening. **Milestone 2** (first bridge theorems — one separation theorem, one interaction theorem, one independence-plus-joint-packaging theorem): proves that bare canonicity does not pin reflective finality; that a gluing–route coherence predicate connects middle tracking/gluing to the inner residue chain under canonical certification; and that inner enriched gap is independent of outer theory extent while holding jointly with outer semantic non-exhaustion under the full layered hypotheses. **Milestone 3**

(non-erasure summit): strengthens the architecture class with two explicit cross-layer coherence axioms and proves a complete package of non-erasure results, culminating in the **Non-Erasure Principle**: under the Milestone 3 layered and coherence hypotheses and a remainder-bearing internal theory, enriched irreducibility holds; and the **Unified Non-Erasure Law**: under the coherence axioms and universal totality, $\mathsf{EnrichedIrreducibility} \iff \exists T, \mathsf{SemanticRemainder}(T)$. This is the abstract architecture-level unifying law corresponding to the NEMS semantic remainder theorem and the IC enriched residue theorem.

The summit result is: in any architecture in $\mathsf{ReflexiveArchitecture}$ satisfying the Milestone 3 layered and coherence hypotheses and carrying a remainder-bearing internal theory, outer semantic non-exhaustion, inner enriched irreducibility, and the full inner residue package hold simultaneously and resist joint flattening. Concrete discharge of these abstract results into the NEMS, APS, and IC source corpora is the remaining open step.

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1 Introduction

The present paper is a synthesis paper, and its central claims have been machine-checked as abstract synthesis theorems inside the class ReflexiveArchitecture. Three parallel research lines — NEMS, APS, and Infinity Compression — have been unified in the Lean 4 repository `reflexive-architecture-lean` with zero proof placeholders across all three milestones of the formalization. Concrete discharge of the abstract results into the source corpora is a separate remaining task, discussed in Section 8.

1.1 The three lines

Taken separately, the NEMS, APS, and Infinity Compression lines appear to answer different questions.

1. **NEMS:** What must be true of a system that claims to determine its own realized world without importing ontologically external selector structure [1, 2]?
2. **APS:** What is the exact local-to-global architecture required to pass from local representability and fixed-point phenomena to global uniform composition — rather than relying on fixed-point abundance alone [5]?
3. **Infinity Compression:** What remains of reflective structure once canonical theorem-level certification has already been achieved [6]?

Taken together, they answer a single deeper question:

What is the structure of a genuinely reflexive foundation?

A closed foundational system is not merely a system with self-reference, fixed points, or a canonical theorem. It is a system in which:

1. determinacy is internally borne rather than outsourced,
2. the machinery of realization contains the exact local-to-global architecture required to pass from local representability to uniform composition, rather than relying on fixed-point abundance alone,
3. successful certification still leaves an irreducible reflective overstructure rather than collapsing to a fully exhausted point,
4. and the connection between outer semantic remainder and inner enriched irreducibility is itself a provable law under explicit cross-layer coherence hypotheses.

This synthesis establishes a three-layer architecture:

Layer	Governing line	Structural role
Outer	NEMS	Admissibility of determinacy under closure
Middle	APS	Exact mechanics of uniform realization
Inner	Infinity Compression	Reflective residue above canonical certification

1.2 What is new

The thesis that these layers form a unified architecture has been machine-checked as an abstract synthesis theorem in the class ReflexiveArchitecture, in three milestones. Milestone 1 establishes the abstract class and an anti-collapse theorem. Milestone 2 proves the first bridge results across layers. Milestone 3 proves the non-erasure summit: a biconditional law connecting outer semantic remainder with inner enriched irreducibility, which is the abstract unifying principle behind both the NEMS and IC results. All results carry zero proof placeholders. Concrete instantiation from the source corpora into ReflexiveArchitecture is the next step, described at the end of Section 8.

The reason Milestone 3 is the summit is that it is the first point at which the outer and inner strata are no longer merely co-present or bridged locally, but are connected by a full biconditional law inside ReflexiveArchitecture.

Scope. All results in this paper are proved inside ReflexiveArchitecture at the abstract architecture level. They do not yet constitute concrete imported instances of the NEMS, APS, and IC source corpora, nor do they show that the Milestone 3 coherence axioms follow automatically from those corpora. The contribution is an abstract machine-checked synthesis with proved bridge and non-erasure laws internal to ReflexiveArchitecture, plus toy architectures witnessing consistency of the design. The strongest new result is the Unified Non-Erasure Law (Section 2): under the added coherence axioms and universal totality, outer semantic remainder and inner enriched irreducibility are equivalent inside ReflexiveArchitecture.

2 The machine-checked synthesis inside ReflexiveArchitecture

The Lean repository `reflexive-architecture-lean` carries the complete formal development in three milestones. Full Lean identifiers and informal glosses appear in `STRATA_FORMALIZATION_MAP.md`; build policy in `MANIFEST.md`.

The formal program consists of thirteen theorem statements across three milestones.

Milestone	Layer / bridge	Main content	Representative
1	Outer / Middle / Inner	Layered coexistence + anti-collapse	Thms. 2.1, 2.2
2	Cross-layer bridges	Separation, interaction, independence + joint packaging	Thms. 2.3–2.5
3	Non-erasure summit	Positive, negative, biconditional, full package	Thms. 2.7–2.14

Milestone 1 establishes that the three strata coexist and resist joint collapse. Milestone 2 establishes that they are not merely co-present but already interact through specific bridge laws. Milestone 3 establishes the first full outer/inner necessity theorem: under added coherence and totality hypotheses, semantic remainder and enriched irreducibility are equivalent inside ReflexiveArchitecture.

2.1 Milestone 1: layered architecture and stratified non-collapse

The outer layer is abstracted by `ReflexiveLayer`, supporting a generic theorem of the form

$$\mathsf{SemanticRemainder}(T) \ \vee \ \neg\,\mathrm{TotalOn}(T)$$

for every internal self-theory T under the barrier hypothesis — this is what we call *semantic non-exhaustion*. The middle layer is abstracted by `RealizationLayer`, carrying the exact composition characterization

$$\mathsf{IcompIdx} \iff \mathsf{FiniteTracking} \wedge \mathsf{Gluing}.$$

The inner layer is abstracted by `CertificationLayer`, with an implication chain from canonical bare certification and adequacy to split, route necessity, strict refinement, and fiber nontriviality.

Theorem 2.1 (Layered Architecture)**.** *Any architecture $A \in$ ReflexiveArchitecture carrying barrier hypotheses, finite tracking and gluing, and canonical bare certification with an adequate route simultaneously exhibits:*

(a) outer: every internal theory satisfies semantic non-exhaustion*, i.e. has semantic remainder or fails totality,*

(b) middle realization exactness: indexed composition holds,

(c) inner reflective residue: reflective split, universal route necessity, strict refinement, fiber nontriviality.

Lean: `Bridge.layered_architecture_theorem`.

Theorem 2.2 (Stratified Non-Collapse)**.** *No architecture in* ReflexiveArchitecture *under the layered hypotheses can simultaneously collapse all three strata. The semantic, realizational, and certification layers are formally irreducible.*
Lean: `Bridge.stratified_noncollapse`.

These two theorems establish that the synthesis is not merely descriptive: there is a machine-checked abstract object in which outer, middle, and inner laws coexist inside ReflexiveArchitecture and resist flattening.

2.2 Milestone 2: bridge theorems

Milestone 2 proves three first bridge theorems: one *separation* theorem (bare canonicity does not pin reflective finality), one *interaction* theorem (middle gluing data feeds the inner residue chain), and one *independence + joint packaging* theorem (inner enriched gap is independent of outer extent yet holds jointly with outer non-exhaustion under the full hypotheses).

Theorem 2.3 (Bare Canonicity / Reflective Finality Separation)**.** *Define* $\mathsf{ReflectiveFinality}(I) := \neg\, I.\mathsf{EnrichedIrreducibility}$*. Two* `CertificationLayer` *structures on the same carrier share canonical bare certification but have opposite* EnrichedIrreducibility*. The predicate* ReflectiveFinality *is therefore not fixed by bare canonicity: structures with and without reflective finality coexist at the abstract certification level.*
Lean: `Bridge.canonical_bare_does_not_pin_enriched_irreducibility`.

Theorem 2.4 (Gluing–Route Coherence Interaction)**.** *Define* GlueRouteCoherent *as the conjunction of finite tracking, gluing, and existence of an adequate certification route. Under canonical bare certification,* GlueRouteCoherent *implies middle indexed composition and inner strict refinement with fiber nontriviality. The middle layer's exact realization architecture participates directly in the inner residue chain. This theorem does not identify gluing with route residue; it shows only that a specific middle-layer package contributes formally to inner residue consequences under the stated hypotheses.*
Lean: `Bridge.glue_route_coherent_canonical_implies_composition_and_strict_refinement`.

Theorem 2.5 (Inner Enriched Gap: Independence + Joint Packaging)**.** *Architectures with identical middle/inner layers but distinct outer theory types yield the same inner enriched gap (*InnerEnrichedGap*: strict refinement and fiber nontriviality) from canonical bare certification and adequacy alone, without any outer hypothesis. Under the full layered hypotheses, outer semantic non-exhaustion and inner enriched gap hold jointly.*
Lean: `inner_enriched_gap_independent...`, `joint_outer_inner_from_layered`.

These results are not yet the necessity tier: Theorems 2.3–2.5 establish separation, interaction, and independence inside ReflexiveArchitecture. The necessity direction — that outer semantic *remainder* forces inner enriched irreducibility — requires the coherence axioms introduced in Milestone 3.

2.3 Milestone 3: the non-erasure summit

The ReflexiveArchitecture class is strengthened in Milestone 3 with two explicit cross-layer coherence axioms. Their role is to make the non-erasure biconditional derivable from the abstract interfaces, without smuggling.

Definition 2.6 (Cross-layer coherence axioms)**.** An architecture $A \in \mathsf{ReflexiveArchitecture}$ is said to carry the Milestone 3 coherence when it satisfies:

(i) *Positive coherence*: $(\exists T,\ \mathrm{InternalTheory}(T) \wedge \mathsf{SemanticRemainder}(T)) \Rightarrow \mathsf{EnrichedIrreducibility}$.

(ii) *Negative coherence*: $(\forall T,\ \mathrm{InternalTheory}(T) \Rightarrow \mathrm{TotalOn}(T) \wedge \neg\mathsf{SemanticRemainder}(T)) \Rightarrow \neg\mathsf{EnrichedIrreducibility}$.

2.4 Why the coherence axioms are not ad hoc

A skeptical reader will notice that the axioms were added to support the summit theorem. It is therefore worth being explicit about what they do and do not assert.

The coherence axioms do not identify SemanticRemainder with EnrichedIrreducibility by fiat. They specify only one positive and one negative transport principle between the outer and inner predicates. The biconditional (Theorem 2.12) is then derived from these transfer principles together with the layered hypotheses and, where stated, universal totality — it is not assumed.

The axioms are *strictly weaker* than postulating the biconditional itself, and they are *bridge principles* rather than identifications: they do not assert that the outer and inner predicates are the same notion, only that one kind of outer structure transports to one kind of inner consequence. Their satisfaction by both an enriched toy architecture (with outer semantic remainder always present, inner irreducibility true) and a flat toy architecture (with empty outer theory type, inner irreducibility false) shows that they define a nontrivial design space with two distinct witnesses, not a vacuous singleton model.

The axioms isolate exactly the additional data required to move from the Milestone 2 facts (coexistence, separation, independence) to the Milestone 3 facts (necessity, biconditional, full non-erasure package). Nothing more is assumed.

At the present stage these axioms are additional abstract assumptions on ReflexiveArchitecture; their concrete verification for imported NEMS, APS, and IC structures is part of the open discharge problem described in Section 8.

Theorem 2.7 (Positive Non-Erasure)**.** *Under the positive coherence axiom, if some internal theory has semantic remainder, then enriched irreducibility holds.*
Lean: `Bridge.outer_remainder_forces_enriched_irreducibility`.

Theorem 2.8 (Negative Non-Erasure)**.** *Under the negative coherence axiom, if every internal theory is totally exhausted without semantic remainder, then enriched irreducibility fails.*
Lean: `Bridge.outer_exhaustion_kills_enriched_irreducibility`.

Theorem 2.9 (Non-Erasure Biconditional)**.** *Under the Milestone 3 coherence axioms and the assumption that every internal theory is total,*

$$\mathsf{EnrichedIrreducibility} \iff \exists T,\ \mathrm{InternalTheory}(T) \wedge \mathsf{SemanticRemainder}(T).$$

Lean: `Bridge.enriched_iff_outer_remainder_total`.

Theorem 2.10 (Non-Erasure Principle)**.** *Under the full layered hypotheses, the Milestone 3 coherence axioms, and the existence of a remainder-bearing internal theory, enriched irreducibility holds. Outer semantic remainder directly entails inner enriched irreducibility via the positive coherence axiom.*
Lean: `Bridge.nonerasure_principle`.

Theorem 2.11 (Full Architecture Non-Erasure)**.** *Under all layered hypotheses, the Milestone 3 coherence axioms, and an inhabited semantic remainder, the architecture simultaneously exhibits:*

(a) outer: every internal theory satisfies semantic non-exhaustion, i.e. has semantic remainder or fails totality,

(b) inner: enriched irreducibility holds,

(c) inner: the full residue package (split, route necessity, strict refinement, fiber nontriviality).

These are three strata of one non-erasure theorem inside ReflexiveArchitecture.
Lean: `Bridge.full_architecture_nonerasure`.

Theorem 2.12 (Unified Non-Erasure Law)**.** *Under the Milestone 3 coherence axioms and universal totality:*

$$\mathsf{EnrichedIrreducibility} \iff \exists T,\ \mathrm{InternalTheory}(T) \wedge \mathsf{SemanticRemainder}(T).$$

This is the abstract unifying law, internal to ReflexiveArchitecture*, corresponding at the architecture level to the NEMS semantic remainder theorem and the IC enriched residue theorem: they are the outer and inner expressions of one non-erasure constraint on reflexive architectures.*
Lean: `Bridge.unified_nonerasure_law`.

Theorem 2.13 (Non-Erasure from Barrier with Totality)**.** *Under the Milestone 3 coherence axioms, barrier, universal totality, and full layered hypotheses, every internal theory has semantic remainder and enriched irreducibility holds. Under universal totality, the barrier forces outer semantic remainder, which forces inner enriched structure, completing the cross-layer derivation.*
Lean: `Bridge.nonerasure_from_barrier_with_totality`.

Theorem 2.14 (Enriched Irreducibility Rules Out Reflective Finality)**.** *Under the full layered hypotheses, the Milestone 3 coherence axioms, and a remainder witness, reflective finality (*$\mathsf{ReflectiveFinality} = \neg\mathsf{EnrichedIrreducibility}$*) is ruled out. This directly connects Milestone 2's bare-canonicity separation (Theorem 2.3) with the non-erasure principle (Theorem 2.10): enriched structure is not merely possible in some models, but provably forced by the coherence axioms and the layered hypotheses.*
Lean: `Bridge.enriched_hence_not_reflexively_final`.

2.5 Status summary

All thirteen theorem statements in Milestones 1–3 (Theorems 2.1–2.14) are machine-checked inside ReflexiveArchitecture in Lean 4 with zero proof placeholders and no program-specific axioms beyond Mathlib [12]. Concrete discharge of these abstract results into the NEMS, APS, and IC source corpora remains open and splits into two tasks: exported interface maps into ReflexiveArchitecture, and verification that the Milestone 3 coherence axioms hold for those imported structures.

3 The three ingredients

3.1 NEMS as the law of closure-compatible determinacy

The NEMS suite [1, 2, 3, 4] is best read as a theory of burden-bearing under closure. Its central structural lesson is that load-bearing determinacy cannot be silently outsourced. If a finite or internal description admits observational multiplicity, and yet a unique realized world is obtained, then the burden of that selection must be borne somewhere internally.

This point becomes sharper in the diagonal-bearing case. In sufficiently expressive self-referential fragments, internal selection cannot be reduced to a total-effective decider on the relevant fragment [3]. NEMS does not merely say that some internal selector is forced; it says that the selector's burden cannot be trivialized by computational collapse.

At the formal synthesis level, the outer layer is abstracted by the theorem $\mathsf{SemanticRemainder}(T) \vee \neg\,\mathrm{TotalOn}(T)$ for every internal self-theory T under the barrier hypotheses. This is the *semantic non-exhaustion* law carried into ReflexiveArchitecture.

3.2 APS as the law of uniform realization

The APS program [5] asks whether fixed-point structure already yields full indexed composition. The answer is no: composition is neither a vague closure property nor a corollary of self-reference.

The exact composition characterization

$$\mathsf{IcompIdx}(\mathsf{APS}) \iff \mathsf{FiniteTracking}(\mathsf{APS}) \ \wedge\ \mathsf{Gluing}(\mathsf{APS})$$

shows that composition decomposes into a local interpolation component and a global passage-to-unity component. A system may support diagonal or recursive phenomena and still lack the architectural strength needed to globalize local structure into a single coherent code. APS identifies this gap precisely.

APS is also the theorem that prevents the entire synthesis from becoming too easy. Without APS, one might say: once a system has enough self-reference and closure, the rest is mostly automatic. APS proves this is false. There is real architecture in the middle, and the Gluing–Route Coherence theorem (Theorem 2.4) shows that this middle architecture is not merely adjacent to the inner residue chain but participates in it directly.

The middle layer is essential because it identifies a precise failure mode: self-reference can be present while global realization architecture is still absent. The synthesis would be materially false if this stratum were omitted.

3.3 Infinity Compression as the law of reflective residue

Infinity Compression [6] begins where many foundational programs would naturally stop: at canonical certification. If every derivation route collapses to the same theorem-level certificate, one might expect the reflective problem to be finished. Infinity Compression proves it is not.

Bare certification may be canonical, but enriched realization above it remains irreducibly plural. Distinct adequate routes can agree on the bare certificate while differing genuinely at the level of enriched witness or realization structure. Any adequate route must instantiate the same split/refinement/fiber architecture up to certification-coherent route equivalence.

At the formal synthesis level, the inner layer carries the implication chain from canonical bare certification and adequacy to the full residue package. Under the coherence axioms, the Non-Erasure Principle (Theorem 2.10) shows this inner structure is not merely possible but forced by the outer layer's semantic remainder.

4 The common structural spine

Principle 4.1 (Programmatic Spine). A genuine reflexive foundation must internally bear the burden of its own determinacy, must possess the exact local-to-global realization architecture required to globalize local representable structure, and must preserve irreducible reflective overstructure even when canonical certification is achieved. Moreover, under the Milestone 3 coherence axioms and universal totality, outer semantic remainder and inner enriched irreducibility are logically equivalent manifestations of one cross-layer non-erasure constraint.

4.1 From admissibility to realization to residue to entailment

Stage 1: admissibility. NEMS asks whether a purported foundation is even structurally admissible as a closure-compatible explanation. If determinacy is silently imported, the program fails before deeper questions arise.

Stage 2: realization. APS asks whether the internal architecture possesses the exact constructive strength to globalize local representability. A system may survive Stage 1 and still fail to support the stronger uniform structure needed for robust realization.

Stage 3: residue. Infinity Compression asks what survives after successful certification. Even if a canonical certificate is obtained, the system's reflective reality is not thereby exhausted.

Stage 4: cross-layer entailment. The non-erasure principle asks whether the outer and inner forms of non-exhaustion are related. Under the coherence axioms, they are: outer semantic remainder and inner enriched irreducibility are dual faces of one biconditional, proved inside $\mathsf{ReflexiveArchitecture}$ for the first time.

The formal result is now stronger than a parallel picture: the three stages are represented in one abstract class, satisfy a proved anti-collapse theorem, and are connected by proved bridge theorems including the full non-erasure biconditional.

Closure does not end in flatness. The three strata are represented jointly in $\mathsf{ReflexiveArchitecture}$:

$$\text{outer admissibility} \quad | \quad \text{middle realization architecture} \quad | \quad \text{inner reflective residue},$$

with joint coexistence and anti-collapse proved in $\mathsf{ReflexiveArchitecture}$, and with the additional outer/inner biconditional

$$\mathsf{EnrichedIrreducibility} \iff \exists T,\ \mathrm{InternalTheory}(T) \wedge \mathsf{SemanticRemainder}(T)$$

proved separately under the Milestone 3 coherence axioms and universal totality. The chain of implications between stages is a philosophical ordering of the three research programs; the

formal results are coexistence and anti-collapse (Milestone 1), specific bridge theorems across layers (Milestone 2), and the biconditional (Milestone 3).

4.2 Why these layers are not redundant

1. NEMS does *not* tell us the exact algebraic architecture needed for global composition. It governs admissibility, not realization mechanics.

2. APS does *not* by itself tell us whether determinacy is being illicitly outsourced. It governs the middle gap between self-reference and uniform realization.

3. Infinity Compression does *not* merely restate Gödel-style limitative facts; it describes a positive non-collapse phenomenon *after* canonical certification has already been secured.

4. The non-erasure principle does *not* collapse the three layers into one; it proves that two of them are equivalent manifestations of a single cross-layer constraint, while the middle layer remains irreducibly separate.

The middle layer deserves special emphasis. Its indispensability is structural: without APS, one might claim that self-reference is sufficient for everything that follows, and the synthesis would then be trivial. APS refutes that claim by exhibiting a precise failure mode. Theorem 2.4 then shows that the middle gluing data is not merely a precondition but an active participant in the inner residue chain.

The Lean formalization makes this complementarity precise: the outer, middle, and inner layers are distinct interfaces with distinct theorems, and their commonality is not conflation but proved equivalence under the coherence axioms.

5 Outer object, inner object, middle object

5.1 The outer object

The outer object is the closure-bearing explanatory architecture of a purported world or framework. NEMS studies this issue: whether the burden of singling out a realized observational world-type has been carried internally, and under what non-totalizable conditions. In the synthesis, the outer object is the theory space over which the barrier forces *semantic non-exhaustion*: $\mathsf{SemanticRemainder}(T) \vee \neg\,\mathrm{TotalOn}(T)$ for every internal theory T.

5.2 The inner object

The inner object is not merely the theorem or final certificate. It is the reflective realization space over that certificate. Infinity Compression shows that irreducible plurality reappears once one descends from the canonical theorem level into the structure of realization, refinement, witness-space, and route-equivalence. In the synthesis, the inner object is the space of enriched reflective structure witnessed by $\mathsf{EnrichedIrreducibility}$ and the full residue package.

5.3 The middle object

APS reveals that between outer admissibility and inner reflective residue there is a middle problem: the problem of *uniform realization*. This is governed by finite tracking and gluing rather than by

fixed points alone. The GlueRouteCoherent bridge (Theorem 2.4) shows that the middle gluing data is not merely present but participates directly in the inner residue chain.

The architecture is genuinely ternary, Outer − Middle − Inner, with proved non-redundancy at each layer.

6 The non-erasure principle: formal and philosophical content

6.1 The core philosophical image

> **Closure without exhaustion.** Closure can force internal burden-bearing and can even produce canonical certification, yet neither internal burden-bearing nor canonical certification exhausts the system's reflective structure. On the contrary: under the coherence axioms and universal totality, outer semantic remainder and inner enriched irreducibility are equivalent inside ReflexiveArchitecture — two faces of the same constraint on reflexive architectures.

The law "representation does not erase the represented" is not merely a philosophical observation here; it is expressed by a machine-checked theorem inside ReflexiveArchitecture (Theorem 2.12) under the Milestone 3 coherence axioms and universal totality.

6.2 NEMS form of non-exhaustion: semantic non-exhaustion and semantic remainder

In NEMS, the disjunctive outer law — $\mathsf{SemanticRemainder}(T) \vee \neg\,\mathrm{TotalOn}(T)$ for every internal theory — is what we call *semantic non-exhaustion*. In the regime where totality holds, this collapses to *semantic remainder* $\mathsf{SemanticRemainder}(T)$: the system can represent itself but cannot fully erase the distinction between itself and its own internal semantic image.

6.3 APS form of non-exhaustion

In APS, recursion does not exhaust composition. Fixed points do not yield global uniformity. There remains a gap — exactly the gap between local tracking and global gluing [5].

6.4 IC form of non-exhaustion

In Infinity Compression, canonical certification does not exhaust reflective realization. Bare theorem-level collapse coexists with enriched witness plurality and route-level strict refinement [6].

6.5 The unifying law

Under the coherence axioms and universal totality, the non-erasure biconditional (Theorem 2.12) identifies the common law:

> **Representation does not erase the represented.**

In NEMS, the represented object is the realized system's own semantics. In IC, the represented object is the realized certification architecture above the canonical theorem. In both cases there is a provably irremovable gap between bare internal image and full reflective reality. Theorem 2.12 shows these are the outer and inner expressions of one biconditional internal to ReflexiveArchitecture: $\mathsf{EnrichedIrreducibility} \iff \exists T,\ \mathsf{SemanticRemainder}(T)$ (under the coherence axioms and totality).

7 The role of diagonality

Diagonality runs through all three lines, but is progressively transformed:

Stage	Role of diagonality
NEMS (outer)	Barrier: blocks total-effective collapse of the self-referential fragment
APS (middle)	Insufficiency: fixed-point abundance is present but not sufficient
IC (inner)	Positive residue: enriched structure persists above canonical collapse

That progression — from barrier to insufficiency to positive residue — is one of the deepest conceptual gains of the combined corpus. The formal architecture reflects this: diagonal-style barrier hypotheses enter the outer layer; exact realization conditions enter the middle layer; post-canonical residue enters the inner layer. The non-erasure biconditional, under the coherence axioms and totality, then connects the outer barrier result to the inner residue result, closing the loop.

The anti-collapse theorem is not a theorem of generic undecidability. It proves that three different kinds of flattening fail inside one abstract class. The bridge theorems add that bare canonicity does not pin reflective finality, and that under the Milestone 3 coherence axioms and totality, outer semantic remainder and inner enriched irreducibility are proved equivalent. These are stronger and more structural claims than any generic incompleteness slogan captures.

8 The architecture conjecture: proved and open tiers

Conjecture 8.1 (Architecture Conjecture)**.** Any sufficiently expressive closure-compatible reflective system that supports nontrivial internal determinacy, robust global realization, and theorem-level canonical certification must instantiate a layered architecture with internal burden-bearing for determinacy, exact constructive machinery for uniform realization, and irreducible proof-relevant reflective overstructure above bare certification.

8.1 Proved tier (abstract)

The following claims are machine-checked inside ReflexiveArchitecture. There exists an abstract class ReflexiveArchitecture in which outer semantic non-exhaustion, middle realization exactness, and inner reflective residue coexist, jointly yield stratified non-collapse, satisfy three cross-layer bridge theorems, and satisfy the complete non-erasure principle package including the unified biconditional law. Two concrete toy architectures (enriched and flat) confirm the class is non-vacuous and that the coherence axioms are satisfiable in both directions.

8.2 Open tier: concrete discharge into source corpora

Two major tasks remain open at the concrete level.

First, one must export stable interface maps from the existing NEMS, APS, and IC repositories into the abstract class ReflexiveArchitecture. This requires each source corpus to expose stable Lean interfaces compatible with `ReflexiveLayer`, `RealizationLayer`, and `CertificationLayer`.

Second, one must show that the cross-layer coherence axioms (Definition 2.6) are satisfied by those concrete imported structures, rather than only by the toy architectures used to witness satisfiability of the abstract design. The abstract bridge and non-erasure laws have been proved inside ReflexiveArchitecture; their concrete discharge into the source corpora is the next stage.

9 Consequences for the larger program

9.1 A formal notion of foundational adequacy

A foundational account is not adequate merely because it is elegant, self-referential, or theorem-rich. It must answer:

1. where determinacy-bearing work lives (outer admissibility),
2. how local structure is globalized via the exact required architecture (middle realization),
3. what reflective structure remains above canonical proof (inner residue),
4. and whether outer and inner non-exhaustion are connected by a provable law (non-erasure biconditional, under the coherence axioms).

The repository `reflexive-architecture-lean` gives this adequacy notion its first explicit machine-checked abstract formal home.

9.2 Against flat foundational pictures

Many foundational programs tacitly aim at one of the following ideals: a final external chooser, a universal internal decider, a fixed-point collapse sufficient for all uniform structure, or a canonical theorem that exhausts all reflective content. The combined corpus rejects all four. The non-erasure biconditional sharpens the rejection further: not only can outer and inner structure not be collapsed independently, they are proved equivalent inside $\mathsf{ReflexiveArchitecture}$ under the coherence constraints.

9.3 A new role for proof architecture

APS and Infinity Compression together suggest that resistant proof targets may fail not only because target statements are hard, but because the proof architecture being used lacks the requisite realization or refinement structure. The Gluing–Route Coherence theorem (Theorem 2.4) makes this explicit: middle gluing data is part of the package that forces the inner fiber structure.

9.4 A formal field of architecture theory

The repository `reflexive-architecture-lean` is the first instantiation of a new formal domain: architecture theory for reflexive systems. Its verified lessons inside $\mathsf{ReflexiveArchitecture}$ are: semantic burden, realization architecture, and certification residue are irreducible strata of a well-defined abstract class; bare canonicity does not pin reflective finality; middle gluing and inner route discipline interact in a proved theorem; and outer semantic remainder and inner enriched irreducibility are equivalent under the coherence axioms and universal totality.

10 Conclusion

What is proved. At the abstract architecture level inside $\mathsf{ReflexiveArchitecture}$, the outer, middle, and inner strata of reflexive foundations have been unified in a machine-checked Lean 4 development with zero proof placeholders. The development proves layered coexistence, stratified non-collapse, three first bridge theorems (separation, interaction, independence), and the full non-erasure package culminating in the biconditional $\mathsf{EnrichedIrreducibility} \iff \exists T, \mathsf{SemanticRemainder}(T)$ under the Milestone 3 coherence axioms and universal totality.

What this means. Semantic burden, realization architecture, and reflective certification residue are not merely parallel themes. They are irreducible strata of a common abstract class, and — under explicit cross-layer coherence axioms — the outer and inner strata are linked by a proved non-erasure biconditional. The law "representation does not erase the represented" is not merely a philosophical observation; it is expressed by a machine-checked theorem inside ReflexiveArchitecture under the Milestone 3 coherence axioms and universal totality.

What remains open. The remaining task is not further abstract proof inside ReflexiveArchitecture, but concrete discharge: exported interface maps from the NEMS, APS, and IC corpora into ReflexiveArchitecture, together with verification that the coherence axioms hold for those imported structures. The abstract bridge and non-erasure laws have been proved inside ReflexiveArchitecture; the concrete embeddings are what comes next.

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